GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

August 31st, 2025
Week 35
Volume 275, Issue 1200

Highlights:

- **Hoping to fire.**
- **Slow supply.**
- **LNGs only?**
- **HKC able.**
- **Wider concerns.**
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QUOTE of the WEEK

"He who conquers himself is the mightiest warrior."

– Confucius

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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SNORING SEPTEMBER?

As August winds down, global markets gave us another week of shy half-gestures and newlywed hesitant moves, all while confidently pretending they were marching somewhere important. Oil traders kept one eye on inventories, the other on geopolitics, and both cockeyed on the clock as WTI closed at USD 64/barrel with Brent just above USD 68—moves so small they looked like rounding errors. Yet the steady draw of about 3 million barrels from U.S. reserves keeps feeding the illusion of momentum heading into September as U.S. oil prices continue to fall, exceeding expectations. The Baltic Dry Index also added its own stage drama, closing at 2,025, the best in a month, but the split beneath the headline was far more telling: Panamaxes up 3.1%, Supramaxes at highs not seen since May 2024, and lumbering Capesizes stumbled on their own wakes thanks to weak iron ore demand. The smaller, nimbler classes seem to be carrying the mood all while the giants' sulk - a sulk that has been slowly charting their return to the recycling beaches of late, week after week.

Tonnage supply this week has however slowed, with fewer arrivals across the Indian sub-continent ship recycling waterfronts that left Bangladesh and Pakistan feeling quieter than recent ledgers suggest, while only a couple of tankers and a tiny supply vessel shuffled onto Alang's sands. Not exactly the flood of post-Covid overaged ships the market had driven its expectations into believing would be happen through the summer of 2025 – much to the industry's dismay. Currencies also added their own spicy theatre to the markets this week with India's Rupee collapsing to record lows, leaving steel price gains looking more like inflation cosplay than real optimism. Pakistan's plate values froze again, and Bangladesh's market looked so bored out of its untraded mind it barely twitched, all while currencies at both destinations remained astray.

Inflation levels only added to the ongoing facade as it is looking less like a synchronized dance and more like a badly rehearsed opera of monkeys. In the U.S., levels stayed steady around 2.7–2.8%, as the Feds keep U.S. interest rates on hold. India played the opposite card, skirting stagflation territory after July's dramatic dip. Bangladesh laced up its sticky mountain shoes and started climbing Mt. Inflation again at 8.5%. Pakistan bounced absurdly from April's 0.3% (the lowest since the 1960s) to 3.5% in May, like inflation had forgotten to show up and then arrived late to the party. China whispered at 0.5%, barely audible, while Turkey, though far better than a year ago, is still screaming at 32.6%, fiscal drama queen hogging center stage while driving Turkish recyclers into oblivion.

Activity overall has slowed under the thick fog of compliance and delivery hurdles ever since the Hong Kong Convention entered into force back in June, chipping away and reducing prospective buyers to a trickle. The few units that do surface often end up in geographically inconvenient waters and fresh out of options, ending up in competing hands. As such, as oil sighs, the Baltic Dry Index flatters itself, Capes sulk, India's Rupee collapses even as steel ticks upward, and only a handful of vessels actually reached the beaches. Pakistan waits, Bangladesh snores, India hedges, and Turkey? Fun, always.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 35 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

MOUNTAINS TO BEACHES!

Lowly.

A lowly Bangladesh market shows no sign of improving, with not a single new vessel arriving the recycling waterfront for a second week in a row — a tragic state of affairs that continues on for what was once the crown jewel of the sub-continent ship recycling markets with the highest prices, strong demand, and voluminous deliveries (for this market's size) week after week.

Yet, over the last couple of months (at least), the market has driven itself into a state of disarray, ever since the HKC kicked into effect, essentially driving this market into the ground with one batch of HKC ready recyclers who have were inundated with yard upgrades and are now trying to recycle through their recent deliveries, at a time recycled ships steel from local ship recycling yards is failing to shift to local steel mills, all while meerkat-ing it for the right / juicy unit that might present itself at the bidding tables. On the other hand, there is that segment of non-HKC ready recyclers who are struggling to get their yards certified and online, eventually leaving this market like pieces of a puzzle board game scattered at a garbage dump, even though the traditionally quieter monsoon months are gradually coming to an end by mid-September.

Deafening silencea.

The deafening silence at local beaches over the last couple of weeks also underscores just how far the Chattogram market has slipped behind its neighbors of late. HKC issues aside, Bangladesh has been struggling to catch to the competition up as local appetite is barely alive and remains narrowly focused on larger LDT units, which unsurprisingly still generate local interest - and that too at some decent numbers strong enough to divert the attention of passing vessels onto Chattogram's shores. Smaller vessels meanwhile attract little to no attention, often being diverted to Pakistan or Alang despite these destinations being at lower levels and given that there are simply no open buyers in Bangladesh for such units.

Lower LDT diverted.

Domestic fundamentals continue to catapult the local mindset onto Mt. Inflation with local steel plate prices flatlining at USD 541.9/ton and the Taka seemingly steadying itself at BDT 121.7 against the U.S. Dollar this week, leaving no pricing incentive to entice prospective ship owners with tonnage. As previously reported, inflation has climbed back to 8.55% in July, further elevating local concerns, costs, and squeezing any potential margins even tighter in the process. As such, most eyes are focusing on the upcoming national elections scheduled for February 2026, where hopes rest on a more progressive administration replacing the inactive and timid interim regime that has thus far, failed to stimulate the economy with any infrastructure projects whatsoever, leaving local recyclers and businesses without the pillars of governmental support. Until this political blanket lifts, this market's sentiment is expected to perform on a paralytic converter.

Trying times

Overall, as Chattogram sits sidelined, India quietly builds momentum on non-ferrous units and Pakistan edges forward with steady prices. For Bangladesh, two straight weeks without a single arrival is not just a statistic — it's a damning marker of how low this market has fallen. Had it not been for the two vessels idling outside, it would've been a big zero for this market. Trying times indeed!

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

HEDGING ON THE EDGE!

Dramatic times.

Alang once again carried the sub-continent's recycling torch standing out as the busiest destination by far this week, registering over double the number of vessels and total LDT of Bangladesh and Pakistan combined. Even local plate prices were on a mission of their own, climbing steadily through the week and offering at least the illusion of ongoing profitable transactions for Alang's recyclers. In the short term? Certainly YAY!! But for the long term, the glow is and will remain dimmer than expected, should the current trends persist.

Rupee woes.

While seven vessels totalling 90,653 LDT were logged for the week in India, a couple were prior arrivals (including a large LDT unit) that have been stranded at anchorage for a few months now. Fresh deliveries in fact, boiled down to just three, a couple of decent LDT tankers and a pint-sized margherita vessel having a ULCC like ego of 281 LDT. This in fact has been a trickle, not a flood — but enough for sparks to fly locally and keep the torches of Alang recyclers lit while their neighbours (especially those in Bangladesh) continue to hit the snooze button on smaller LDT units – week after week.

Price turn.

The irony for India, however, lies in the ongoing performance of its fundamentals that have been malnourished by the actions of the White House as even though local steel plate prices crept up from USD 442.9/ton to 448.9/ton - a healthy gain of USD 6/ton for the week - any optimism was undercut by the collapse of the Rupee, which fell to a disastrous record low of INR 88.3 against the U.S. Dollar and quickly turned cautious confidence into inflation cosplay. What this essentially means for Alang's ship recycling fraternity is that costs are rising faster than margins, leaving this market in pretty much the same place as its competition – and many recyclers observant of this fact remain far more nervous about than pleased. Why? Cause this would certainly have little motivation improve levels or compete or even worse, roll back offers just when the rains are coming to pass, which has traditionally been a busier overall time for the ship recycling industry.

Conservative.

Where India still manages to hold an edge is its heritage of HKC yards and strict compliance. Unlike Bangladesh's paralysis, Alang's yards continue to process HKC-compliant units with ease, keeping the door open for large LDT units and non-ferrous vessels to continue sailing in. Smaller tonnage, however, attracts far less appetite, particularly as currency volatility and Washington's tariff wanderings keep breakers cagey about new commitments. Some of this tonnage has instead found its way to Gadani, where desperate recyclers armed with fresh DASR approvals are willing to pick up what Alang prefers to pass on.

Sentiment overall remains cautious, and India undeniably remains the most active of the sub-continent's markets, but activity should not be confused with bullishness. Deliveries are happening, but these seem more to keep businesses operational rather than supply stacking up to the volumes forecasted of the fabled summer of 2025. Alang is clearly hedging its bets: steel ticking upward, the rupee tumbling downward, HKC paperwork keeping the gates open, but recyclers unwilling to overextend.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

PICKY WHILE HUNGRY!

Stability and intent.

While Indian recyclers kept themselves busy with their deliveries of the week and Bangladeshi recyclers pulled the blankets up above their heads to snooze the week out, the Gadani gang once again proved to be the quiet opportunist bunch they have been i.e., increasingly looking to exploit their precious DASR approvals by vying for juicy tonnage at the bidding tables, which sadly doesn't seem to find a navigational chart to Gadani waters. Only a single vessel was logged for this week compared to the scale of Alang's tankers and even the overall scale of deliveries over recent weeks. Yet what Pakistan lacks in volume, the Gadani gang is clearly making up for in price stability and purchasing intent.

Work underway.

While the comparative price offerings from Gadani's shores have been the strongest and seemingly the most stable over recent months, its local steel plate prices remain the unwitting stars of the show as they continue to hold firm at USD 621.9/ton, still the highest in the sub-continent and with the greatest of recycling margins in hand. Further confounding their ongoing price and performance is the fact is that the Pakistani Rupee held steady at a recent and decent PKR 281.8 against the U.S. Dollar, which should give the Gadani Gang, the kind of predictable price footing their neighbors continue to envy. This combination has kept Gadani positioned as the top-placed market in the industry, ready to move on viable candidates that may appear — with even having the possibility of diverting vessels away from Bangladesh should the respective owner so choose.

But they continue to fail to do so.

Insulated.

The big story here remains DASR-backed recyclers. After an initially shut down and provisional certificates finally being issued for yards showing real progress toward HKC compliance, development works are underway and for the first time in years, Gadani feels less like an inert option and more like a market trying to claw its way back to relevance. Perhaps most importantly, Pakistan seems the most insulated market (when compared to India and Bangladesh) from the ongoing tariff and sanction soap operas starring reality tv presidents. As India hedges under the weight of Washington's paralyzing trade negotiations and Bangladesh buckles under political disorder, Gadani has a rare window: firm steel, stable currency, and fewer external pressures (at least for the time being).

Without hesitation.

Inflation may have nudged upward — from April's surreal 0.3% low (the weakest since the 1960s) to 3.5% in May — but in the context of ship recycling, stable local fundamentals outweigh macro noise. Gadani's recyclers are hungry, alert, and willing, circling for the "juicier" large LDT units that India sometimes let's pass. As such, the Gadani gang waits — not idle, but to pounce. With solid pricing, steady offers, and DASR-backed yards inching towards compliance, local recyclers are positioned as the underdogs who could still steal the show – seemingly without hesitatio

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

NADA!

Lira and plate prices tumble, vessel levels next? It's literally whatever anymore. On to next week.

Whatever.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 35 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Pakistan	**Steady**	425 / LDT	445 / LDT	455 / LDT
2	India	**Steady**	415 / LDT	435 / LDT	445 / LDT
3	Bangladesh	**Weak**	405 / LDT	425 / LDT	435 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- *Fish Puke Immortalized in Rock - A 66-million-year-old fossilized chunk of fish vomit—complete with bits of sea lilies—was uncovered in Denmark's cliffs. It's now cheekily dubbed the "world's most famous piece of puke."*
- *Interstellar Comet with an Identity Crisis - 3I/ATLAS, only the third confirmed interstellar visitor, surprised scientists when the James Webb Space Telescope found its coma dominated by carbon dioxide, not water. It might be the oldest—and largest—comet ever seen.*
- *Uranus Gets a New Moon - Astronomers spotted a probable new satellite of Uranus, named S/2025 U 1—a tiny 10 km rock lurking just beyond the planet's rings. It's the first moon discovery since 2003.*
- *Holographic Strange Metals - Physicists and philosophers dove into "strange metals," materials that defy conventional physics, by modeling them after four-dimensional black holes in anti–de Sitter space. Yes, you read that right.*
- *Sun's South Pole for the First Time - ESA's Solar Orbiter delivered humanity's first-ever view of the Sun's south pole in June, revealing solar phenomena hidden from us for centuries.*
- *Little STL Louvre: The Oldest 3D Map - Researchers unearthed what may be the oldest human-drawn 3D map, preserved in a cave in the Paris Basin and dating back 13,000 years.*
- *Mummies That Still Smell Spicy - Remarkably, Egyptian mummies over 5,000 years old still emit a "spicy" and "sweet" odor—proving that olfactory history lasts longer than we expected.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No major holidays in September	September 05 = September 14 September 19 – September 27

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
September 05 – Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	September 07 – September 10 September 20 – September 23

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
September 05 – Eid-e-Milad-un-Nabi	August 30 – Victory Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of August 29, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Abdullah F	9,623	Oil Tanker	Arrived August 19
2	*Bow Fagus*	*11,189*	*Chemical Tanker*	*Delivered August 27*
3	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
4	*Muru*	*281*	*Supply Vessel*	*Delivered August 30*
5	**Nirvana**	**9,623**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived May 07**
6	*Simas*	*20,001*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered August 26*
Total Tonnage		**70,718**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of August 29, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	DK 03	7,809	Bulk Carrier	Arrived August 04
2	*Dalian*	*21,414*	*Bulk Carrier*	*Delivered August 23*
		29,223		

GADANI - Port Position as of August 29, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Sister 12	2,261	General Cargo	Arrived August 12
Total Tonnage		**2,261**		

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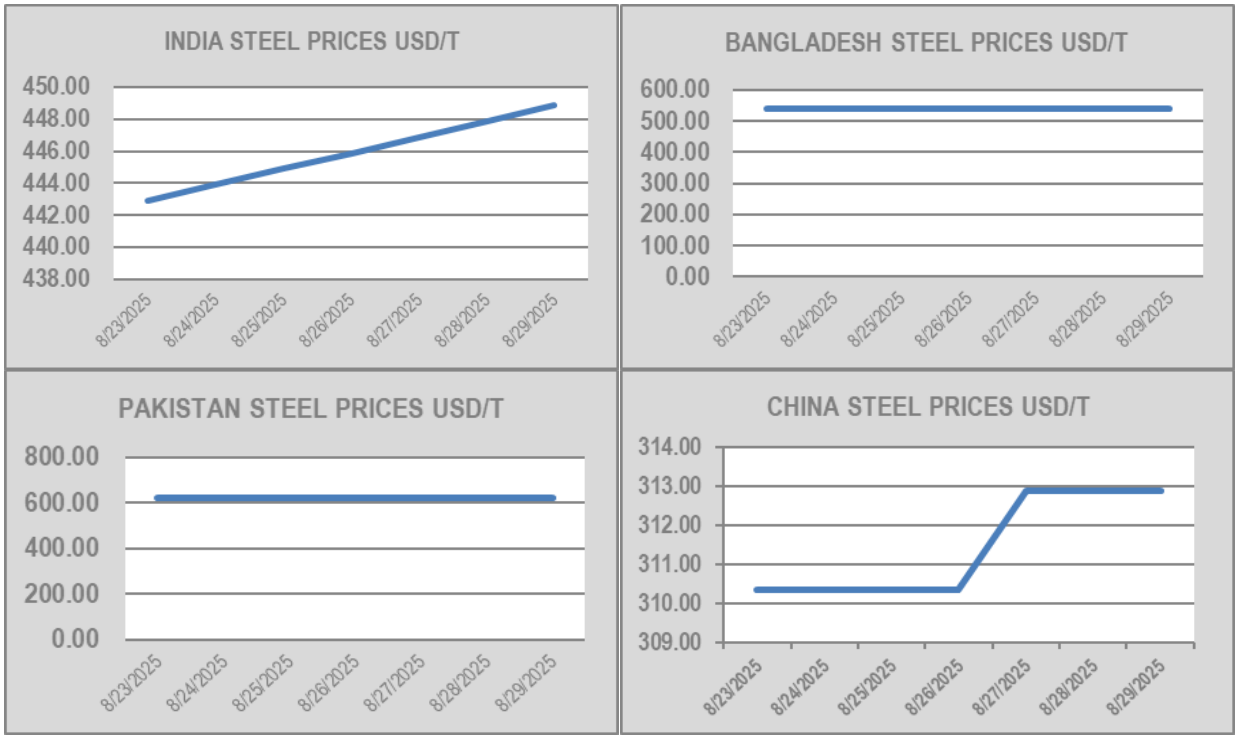
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
8/23/2025	442.88	38,200.00	621.91	176,000.00	541.86	65,700.00	310.35
8/24/2025	443.88	38,200.00	621.91	176,000.00	541.86	65,700.00	310.35
8/25/2025	444.88	38,200.00	621.91	176,000.00	541.86	65,700.00	310.35
8/26/2025	445.88	38,000.00	621.91	176,000.00	541.86	65,700.00	310.35
8/27/2025	446.88	37,800.00	621.91	176,000.00	541.86	65,700.00	312.90
8/28/2025	447.88	37,800.00	621.91	176,000.00	541.86	65,700.00	312.90
8/29/2025	448.88	37,800.00	621.91	176,000.00	541.86	65,700.00	312.90



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